

Opinion of the Court

cumstances that he or she faced.” *Plumhoff, supra*, at 779 (internal quotation marks and citation omitted). A rule is too general if the unlawfulness of the officer’s conduct “does not follow immediately from the conclusion that [the rule] was firmly established.” *Anderson, supra*, at 641. In the context of a warrantless arrest, the rule must obviously resolve “whether ‘the circumstances with which [the particular officer] was confronted . . . constitute[d] probable cause.’” *Mullenix, supra*, at 13 (quoting *Anderson, supra*, at 640–641; some alterations in original).

We have stressed that the “specificity” of the rule is “especially important in the Fourth Amendment context.” *Mullenix, supra*, at 12. Probable cause “turn[s] on the assessment of probabilities in particular factual contexts” and cannot be “reduced to a neat set of legal rules.” *Gates*, 462 U. S., at 232. It is “incapable of precise definition or quantification into percentages.” *Pringle*, 540 U. S., at 371. Given its imprecise nature, officers will often find it difficult to know how the general standard of probable cause applies in “the precise situation encountered.” *Ziglar v. Abbasi*, 582 U. S. 120, 151 (2017). Thus, we have stressed the need to “identify a case where an officer acting under similar circumstances . . . was held to have violated the Fourth Amendment.” *White v. Pauly*, 580 U. S. 73, 79 (2017) (*per curiam*); *e. g.*, *Plumhoff, supra*, at 778–779. While there does not have to be “a case directly on point,” existing precedent must place the lawfulness of the particular arrest “beyond debate.” *al-Kidd, supra*, at 741. Of course, there can be the rare “obvious case,” where the unlawfulness of the officer’s conduct is sufficiently clear even though existing precedent does not address similar circumstances. *Brosseau v. Haugen*, 543 U. S. 194, 199 (2004) (*per curiam*). But “a body of relevant case law” is usually necessary to “‘clearly establish’ the answer” with respect to probable cause. *Ibid.*

Under these principles, we readily conclude that the officers here were entitled to qualified immunity. We start by